

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and part way through a computer science degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto. Replaces manual processes with automation and validated data, gets the people who rely on the output to adopt the change, and reports the results to management.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.
- Identify where a process is not working, coordinate the people needed to change it, and see the change through to adoption.
- Build and maintain the datasets and tooling Transportation Planning depends on, using Python and GIS.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Process automation with Python (Pandas, NumPy) and SQL. Dashboards, KPIs and performance measurement. Data analysis and data-driven recommendations. Advanced Excel and MS Office. Briefing notes, memos and presentations. Stakeholder coordination across divisions and agencies.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)